Bowen **Yi**

Ph.D. Student in Computer Science, University of Southern California

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Research Interests

Human-centered and trust-worthy NLP; multimodal AI; AI for health; computational social science.

Education

Aug. 2025 – Present | **University of Southern California** | **Los Angeles, CA**
Ph.D. in Computer Science • GPA: 3.90/4.00
Advisor: Shrikanth Narayanan

Jan. 2023 – May. 2025 | **University of Michigan, Ann Arbor** | **Ann Arbor, MI**
B.S. in Computer Science • GPA: 3.79/4.00

Sep. 2021 – Dec. 2022 | **University of California, San Diego (Transferred)** | **La Jolla, CA**
B.S. in Mathematics–Computer Science • GPA: 3.83/4.00

Publications and Manuscripts

Peer-Reviewed Publications

[1] **Tracing Moral Foundations in Large Language Models** [paper]
Chenxiao Yu*, **Bowen Yi***, Farzan Karimi-Malekabadi, Suhaib Abdurahman, Jinyi Ye, Shrikanth Narayanan, Yue Zhao, Morteza Dehghani
NeurIPS 2026 (Main Track)

[2] **Towards Interpretable Framework for Neural Audio Codecs via Sparse Autoencoders: A Case Study on Accent Information** [paper]
Shih-Heng Wang, Tiantian Feng, Aditya Kommineni, Thanathai Lertpetchpun, **Bowen Yi**, Xuan Shi, Shrikanth Narayanan
Interspeech 2026

[3] **AI-Augmented Counselor Training for Reflective Listening in Resource-Limited Settings: A Field Study in Honduras**
Longju Bai, John Piette, Do June Min, Darlin Mancia, **Bowen Yi**, Rafael Mejía Perdomo, Ernesto Gálvez-Pineda, Rada Mihalcea, Verónica Pérez-Rosas
ACII 2026

[4] **Real or Robotic? Assessing Whether LLMs Accurately Simulate Qualities of Human Responses in Dialogue** [paper]
Jonathan Ivey*, ..., **Bowen Yi***, ..., David Jurgens
Findings of ACL 2026

[5] **NLP for Social Good: A Survey of Challenges, Opportunities and Responsible Deployment** [paper]
Antonia Karamolegkou, ..., **Bowen Yi**, ..., Daryna Dementieva
EACL 2026 (Oral)

[6] **Examining Spanish Counseling with MIDAS: a Motivational Interviewing Dataset in Spanish** [paper]
Aylin Gunal*, **Bowen Yi***, John Piette, Rada Mihalcea, Verónica Pérez-Rosas
NAACL 2025

[7] **Causally Modeling the Linguistic and Social Factors that Predict Email Response** [paper]
Yinuo Xu*, ..., **Bowen Yi***, ..., David Jurgens
NAACL 2025

[8] **The Generation Gap: Exploring Age Bias Underlying in the Value Systems of Large Language Models** [paper]
Siyang Liu, Trish Maturi, **Bowen Yi**, Siqi Shen, Rada Mihalcea
EMNLP 2024

Manuscripts Under Review and Preprints

[9] **Last Translation Benchmark** [paper]
Vilém Zouhar, ..., **Bowen Yi**, ..., Zaid Alyafeai
arXiv preprint

[10] **De-conflating Preference and Qualification: Constrained Dual-Perspective Reasoning for Job Recommendation with Large Language Models** [paper]
Bryce Kan, Wei Yang, Emily Nguyen, Ganghui Yi, **Bowen Yi**, Chenxiao Yu, Yan Liu
arXiv preprint

Publications and manuscripts (continued)

[11] **Towards Interpretable Framework for Neural Audio Codecs via Sparse Autoencoders: Exploration toward Age, Gender, and Accent Steering** [paper]
Shih-Heng Wang, Tiantian Feng, Aditya Kommineni, Huang-Cheng Chou, **Bowen Yi**, Xuan Shi, Shrikanth Narayanan
Under review at ICASSP 2026

* Equal contribution; author order is randomized where specified by the paper.

Academic Service

Reviewer: EMNLP 2025; ACL 2026; NeurIPS 2026; GenAI4Health @ NeurIPS 2025 and 2026; ACL Rolling Review

Industry Experience

Software Engineering Intern | BoardX Jun. 2023–Aug. 2023
Mentor: Feng Zhang

- Built features for a collaborative digital whiteboard, including Azure-backed data management, AI-assisted ideation, and color-blind-friendly interface elements.

Selected Presentations

- **"Examining Spanish Counseling with MIDAS."** NAACL 2025, Albuquerque, NM; MSLD 2025, Notre Dame, IN. [poster]
- **"Causally Modeling the Linguistic and Social Factors that Predict Email Response."** NAACL 2025, Albuquerque, NM. [poster]
- **"NLP for Enhanced Behavioral Counseling in Spanish."** EMNLP 2024 BoF on Large Multimodal Models for Biomedical Research; Michigan AI Symposium; e-HAIL Symposium.
- **"Can LLMs Simulate Human Subject Studies?"** NLP Reading Group, Michigan AI Lab, September 2024. [slides]

Media Coverage

Language Models for Social Good Aug. 11, 2026
TUM Campus Heilbronn, *Mindshift* | Publication [5]

New research reveals why most emails go unanswered June 28, 2025
Tech Explorist | Publication [7]

Haben Sie Probleme mit ungelesenen E-Mails? June 25, 2025
Zahnärztliche Mitteilungen (in German) | Publication [7]

Having problems with unread emails? Entice the recipients with more emotion June 23, 2025
Phys.org (University of Michigan news release) | Publication [7]

Honors and Awards

Center for Computational Language Sciences (CCLS) Seed Funding, 2026 | University of Southern California

Viterbi School of Engineering Fellowship, 2025–2026 | University of Southern California

James B. Angell Scholar, 2025 | University of Michigan

University Honors, 2023–2025 | University of Michigan

IEEE–Eta Kappa Nu, 2022 & 2024 | UC San Diego & University of Michigan

Provost Honors, 2021–2022 | UC San Diego

Teaching and Leadership

Grader, EECS 486: Information Retrieval | University of Michigan Jan. 2025–Apr. 2025

- Graded programming assignments, exams, and final projects and provided detailed feedback to more than 100 students.

NLP Reading Group | University of Michigan *Co-Organizer* Sep. 2024–Apr. 2025

- Co-organized weekly research presentations and grew an interdisciplinary community of 180 members across computing, medicine, and psychology.

Skills

Machine Learning	PyTorch, TensorFlow, Hugging Face Transformers, scikit-learn
Programming	Python, C/C++, Java, HTML/CSS
Languages	Hunanese and Mandarin (native), English (fluent)